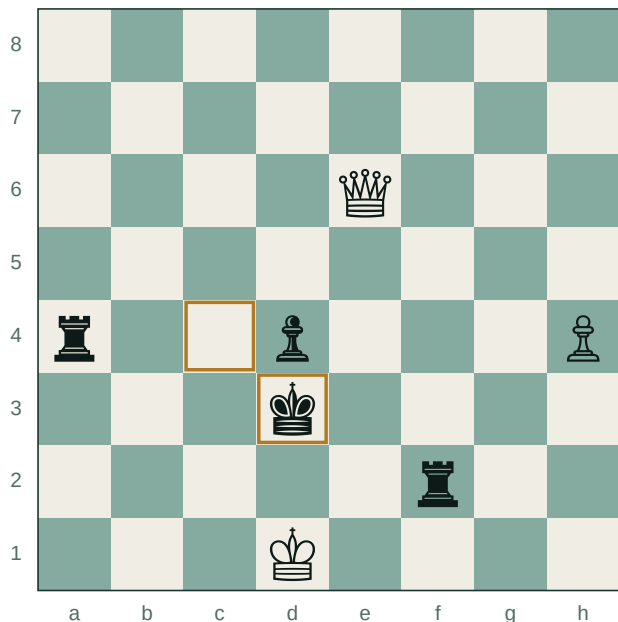


# Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 55

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 54...Kd3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 55. Qb3+ Ke4 56. Qxa4

**55.Qb3+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From b3 it attacks king on d3 and rook on a4. Recorded reply: **55...Ke4**.

**56.Qxa4** The queen captures the rook on a4.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

### CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

### HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on d3. Geometrically undefended: rook on a4 and rook on f2. Check for tactical protection.